

Lauren Briana Schwartz

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Instructional designer with 16 years in higher education and adult learning, designing instructor-led, virtual, blended, and online training for faculty, staff, and adult learners. Manages the full design cycle with subject matter experts, from needs analysis and measurable learning objectives through development, evaluation, and revision. Built required accessibility training that raised institutional LMS accessibility scores from 82% to 90% in one semester, ahead of the April 2026 ADA Title II deadline; materials now shared with instructional designers at all 19 New Jersey community colleges. Administers Canvas LMS for 250+ courses per semester and presents statewide and nationally on learning design.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Salem Community College — Carneys Point, NJ

2013 – present

Instructional Development Specialist

July 2026 – present

Academic Technology Coordinator

2022 – 2026

- Manage the full instructional design cycle (analysis, design, development, implementation, evaluation) with faculty subject matter experts for instructor-led, virtual, blended, and online courses; write measurable learning objectives and aligned assessments.
- Co-designed the ENG101 OER Master Course with English faculty, a shared repository of open readings, assignments, slide decks, and sample syllabi supporting the department's transition from commercial textbooks.
- Designed *Accessibility Safari*, a gamified training built around the five highest-impact accessibility errors identified through an institution-wide audit (164 courses, 17,000+ flagged issues); delivered as required training to approximately 100 full-time and adjunct faculty (January 2026).
- Raised average LMS course accessibility score from 82% to 90% in one semester, meeting the institutional compliance target ahead of the April 2026 ADA Title II deadline; sustained 89–90% as monitoring grew to 217 courses.
- Adapted the training into an awareness-focused version with an interactive practice activity for all full-time staff (March 2026); shared materials statewide through the NJCCC Distance Education Affinity Group, which connects instructional designers from all 19 New Jersey community colleges (July 2026).
- Designed and maintain the Adjunct & Faculty Training Portal, a self-paced onboarding and professional development course serving 150 instructors.
- Lead faculty AI literacy and AI-era assessment work: designed a multi-module AI Literacy Training Course launching institution-wide in November 2026, authored an AI governance brief for academic leadership on detection tools and academic integrity, and guide faculty on AI-forward and AI-resistant assignment design.
- Administer Canvas LMS for 250+ courses per semester and its full LTI ecosystem, including CidiLabs DesignPLUS (course authoring and screen reader testing), UDOIT, ReadyGO, Perusall, and Padlet; hold sole institutional ownership of UDOIT accessibility remediation and ReadyGO course-readiness review.
- Authored the vendor evaluation and renewal recommendation for eLumen Insights, aligning the platform to MSCHE Standard V; the platform enabled the first assessment in years for previously unassessed programs and broadened adjunct participation.
- Co-Chair, Outcomes Assessment Committee (2022–2024); primary academic technology representative for the MSCHE accreditation site visit (April 2025), presenting on instructional effectiveness and Standard V outcomes alignment.
- Develop original instructional tools hosted on GitHub Pages (CLEAR, Caption Wrangler, AI Readiness Inventory); lead evaluation and piloting of emerging instructional technologies and coordinate with vendors on implementation.

Adjunct Professor, English and Humanities

2014 – present

- Design and teach in-person, hybrid, and online courses, including experimental ENG101 and ENG102 sections integrating AI literacy into composition.
- Taught incarcerated adult learners through the NJSTEP prison education program at South Woods State Prison, and dual-enrollment students through College Readiness Now grant at Penns Grove High School.
- Designed and analyzed a mixed-methods evaluation of open educational resources (OER) and Perusall social annotation in HUM101, combining a student exit survey with platform analytics.
- Co-Chair, Academic Senate (2022–2023); college ambassador to Princeton University's Convening of the Humanities (April 2025 & April 2026); co-recipient, Academic Excellence Award (2019–2020).

Academic Support Lab Coordinator	2018 – 2022
Senior Instructional Aide / Team Lead	2013 – 2016
- Hired, supervised, and evaluated a team of 8 academic support staff in a high-volume, student-facing operation. - Built remote and hybrid tutoring infrastructure; used usage and retention data to guide staffing, service delivery, and institutional reporting.	
Thomas Jefferson University — Philadelphia, PA	2016 – 2018
Academic Development Specialist, Academic Support Services	
- Designed and delivered workshops and instructional materials for adult learners in health sciences programs across multiple disciplines and campuses. - Hired, trained, and supervised peer tutors and academic support staff across multiple programs in a multi-campus environment.	
Saint Joseph's University — Philadelphia, PA	2010 – 2012
Chief Digital Consultant / Multimedia Laboratory Manager, College of Arts & Sciences	
Managed multimedia lab operations; taught students Photoshop and Final Cut Pro; supervised student employees.	

EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Writing Studies — Saint Joseph's University, Philadelphia, PA	2015
<i>Magna Cum Laude Sigma Tau Delta</i>	
Bachelor of Arts in English (Writing) — Saint Joseph's University, Philadelphia, PA	2011
<i>Dean's List Sigma Tau Delta Transfer Achievement Award</i>	
Gloucester County College (now Rowan College of South Jersey), Sewell, NJ	2004 – 2006
<i>Dean's List President's List Phi Theta Kappa NJSTARS Scholarship</i>	

SKILLS & TOOLS

Instructional design: ADDIE-based design cycle, needs analysis, measurable learning objectives, assessment and rubric design, adult learning, training evaluation, SME collaboration

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, ADA Title II compliance, screen reader testing (DesignPLUS), UDOIT remediation, caption review

Learning technology: Canvas LMS administration, DesignPLUS, UDOIT, ReadyGO, eLumen Insights, Perusall, Padlet, GitHub Pages

Authoring & multimedia: Adobe Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Acrobat Pro; Canva; PowerPoint; Google Slides

Engagement: Mentimeter, Kahoot, Poll Everywhere

Survey & data: Microsoft Forms, Google Forms, SurveyMonkey, Excel, Canvas analytics, eLumen Insights dashboards, UDOIT and ReadyGO reporting

Collaboration: Microsoft 365 (SharePoint, Teams, Outlook, Word), Zoom, Google Workspace, Dropbox, Calendly

Compliance: FERPA, ADA, MSCHE accreditation

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

"The Process Is the Point: Taking Assessment Design From 'Did a Student Use AI?' to 'Did a Student Learn?'" *OLC Accelerate 2026, Orlando, FL — Forthcoming November 2026*

"From Prompt to Project: Assessments & AI" *Garden State Distance Learning Workshop Series — Panelist, Forthcoming October 2026*

"AI Impact on Learning" *NJCBA Fall Quarterly Meeting, Brookdale Community College — Panelist, September 2026*

"Outcomes in Canvas: A Nine-Year Institutional Story" *Instructure Canvas CSM Monthly Webinar — Panelist, September 16, 2026 (320+ attendees)*

"Beyond Detection: AI-Forward and AI-Resistant Assignment Design for Authentic Student Learning" *NJ Community College Opportunity Summit, Atlantic City, NJ — June 2026*

"Teaching, Not Policing: Moving Beyond AI Detection in Academic Integrity" *NJCCC Teaching and Learning in the Age of AI, Scotch Plains, NJ — February 2026*

"Ditching the Discussion Board: Building Innovative Tools for Collaboration in Asynchronous Online Classes" *OLC Accelerate, Orlando, FL — November 2022*